

Sonoma County wineries have mixed feelings on Wine Improvement District plan

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Verified key content

- Proposal: consumers would pay 1 to 2 percent additional on tasting-room visits, wine-club memberships within California, and bottles purchased at local wineries.
- Status at publication: no vote; "industry leaders have formed a steering committee to explore creating" the district (exploratory phase).
- Julie Rothberg (Medlock Ames Winery president), supporting: "There's never going to be a good time for this, but why it's so critical now is because everyone's suffering, everyone's hurting, everyone's scared."
- Kathleen Inman (Inman Family Wines founder), opposing: "I was really quite shocked that the message came out directly to all of us wineries rather than having any consultation beforehand." She prefers a production-based assessment and worries even 1% would frustrate consumers.